

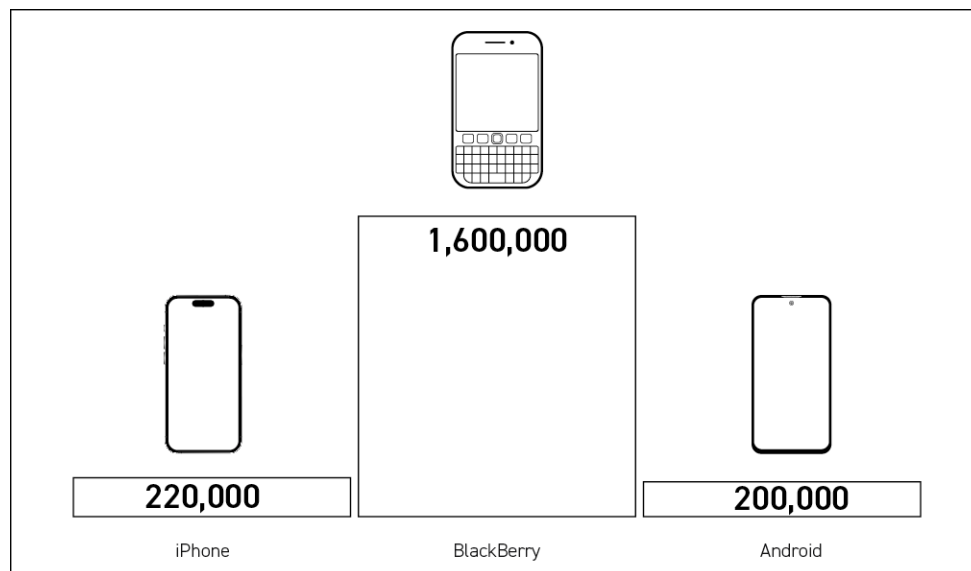
“Forget the iPhone: BlackBerry is still the one to beat”

HOW LITTLE DO we know about the future? One way to figure that out is to look to our past, to see how we imagined the future would unfold.

Another example: This *Fortune* cover story,^{[94](#)} lauding BlackBerry in late summer 2007, is a favorite:

There’s a lot of buzz in the smartphone business lately, with Apple’s (AAPL) iPhone turning the mobile world upside down and Nokia’s (NOK) upcoming phone announcement providing a new challenge. Despite all the hype, though, *Research in Motion’s (RIMM) BlackBerry is still the most formidable force in U.S. smartphones.*

This statement, of course, is gadget heresy. Popular opinion holds that the iPhone is today’s must-have device, and none of the others stand a chance. But while the iPhone is revolutionary, it’s not yet positioned to truly challenge RIM’s foothold in the smartphone market. (Emphasis added.)



The most formidable force in smartphones?